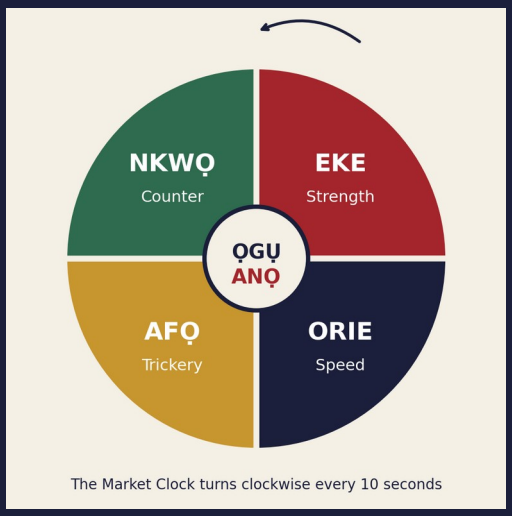
GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT AND PITCH DOSSIER



The Market Clock turns clockwise every 10 seconds

ỌGỤ ANỌ

War of the Four Market Days

A 2D fighting game of Igbo mythology

"Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe."

Four days. One truth. No fifth.

Ike Christopher Ugochukwu | Version 1.0 | October 2026

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1. Executive Summary

Logline

When a fallen priest-king steals the sacred Ọfọ and tears a lawless “Fifth Day” into the Igbo week, a young daughter of the Earth goddess Ala must fight through a tournament of gods, ancestors and spirits to restore the Four Market Days and the truth they protect.

Ọgụ Anọ: War of the Four Market Days is a 2D story-driven fighting game built entirely on Igbo cosmology, language and values. It delivers the weight, spectacle and mastery of Mortal Kombat and Street Fighter, but replaces gore and generic fantasy with something no fighting game has done properly: a combat system and a story that both grow out of the Igbo four-day market week (Eke, Orie, Afọ, Nkwọ), the authority of the Ọfọ staff, and the Igbo belief that every person walks with a personal Chi.

Title	Ọgụ Anọ: War of the Four Market Days
Title meaning	Ọgụ = fight, war, contest. Anọ = four. “The Fight of Four”: four market days, four spirit keepers, four powers in balance.
Tagline	Four days. One truth. No fifth.
Cultural motto	Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe. (When a person says yes, their Chi says yes.)
Genre	2D narrative fighting game with a story mode, versus, survival and training modes
Platforms	Android (primary, with touch controls), Windows PC (Steam and itch.io), gamepad supported everywhere
Engine	Godot 4 (2D), chosen for its small build size, free licence and strong Android export
Audience	Ages 13+ gamers in Africa and the diaspora, fighting-game fans worldwide, students and educators interested in African heritage
Content rating target	PEGI 12 / ESRB Teen: stylised fantasy violence, no blood or gore
Unique selling points	1. The Market Clock: a combat system built on the Igbo four-day week. 2. Ọfọ Verdict: finishers become moral choices that change the story ending. 3. Authentic Igbo world: language, proverbs, instruments, masquerades and deities. 4. Non-gory, family-safe and school-friendly, yet competitively deep.

The Specialties of this Game Design Document

- **Cultural storytelling.** The story is a complete original myth that stays faithful to real Igbo concepts: Chukwu, Ala, Amadioha, Anyanwụ, Idemmili, Ekwensu, Chi, Ọfọ, Ogbanje, masquerades and ndị ichie.
- **Execution.** A realistic scope: 8 playable fighters, 9 stages, a 9-chapter story, and a clear 13-month production plan using free tools.
- **Market and impact.** Africa has the fastest-growing mobile gaming audience in the world; this game gives it a flagship title that also preserves heritage.

- **Professional package.** Full design document, character sheets, move lists, art and audio direction, technical plan, roadmap, risk register, pitch outline and trailer script.

2. Game Overview

2.1 Concept in one page

Players choose a champion who carries the spiritual power of one of the Igbo deities or traditions. Fights are best-of-three rounds in the style of classic 2D fighters. Between fights, a cinematic, voiced story unfolds across nine chapters. The game plays like a competitive fighter, but looks and sounds like a living Igbo world: ogene gongs ring when a round starts, uli patterns glow when a special meter fills, and proverbs appear as battle quotes.

2.2 Key features

- **The Market Clock:** every fight is divided into the four market days; the active day changes how every character fights.
- **Chi Awakening:** a comeback mechanic where a fighter's Chi rises behind them when near defeat.
- **Ọfọ Verdict:** instead of a gory "fatality", the winner chooses Ebere (Mercy) or Ikpe (Judgement), and the choice shapes the story.
- **Branching story mode:** four endings, including a secret true ending.
- **Igbo language layer:** dialogue, proverbs and move names in Igbo with English subtitles and an in-game glossary.
- **Heritage Codex:** an unlockable encyclopaedia that explains the real myth, history and meaning behind every character, stage and symbol.
- **Mobile-first controls** with a competitive-grade gamepad and keyboard layout.

2.3 How it compares

Game	Setting	How Ọgụ Anọ differs
Mortal Kombat	Western fantasy, realms, extreme gore	Same dramatic tournament format, but a distinctive Igbo setting, no gore, and finishers with moral weight.
Street Fighter	Global martial artists	Ọgụ Anọ has a unifying cultural cosmology and a story-first structure rather than a collection of nationalities.
Tekken	Family drama, martial arts, 3D	Ọgụ Anọ is 2D, mobile-friendly and anchored in one living tradition, with a mechanic derived from that tradition.
Throne of Gods (Black Ring, Nigeria)	Mobile fighter featuring African mythology	Ọgụ Anọ goes deep into one culture (Igbo) instead of sampling many, and adds a signature system (Market Clock) and branching narrative.
SINAG (Ranida Games)	Fighter based on Philippine mythology	Proves global demand for mythology-based fighters; Ọgụ Anọ brings the same idea to Igbo and West African heritage.

3. World and Lore Bible

The world of Ọgụ Anọ is built on real Igbo cosmology, then extended with an original myth. Where the game invents something, the Heritage Codex says so clearly (see Section 12).

3.1 The Cosmos

Realm	Description
Chukwu / Chineke	The supreme creator, the great source of all things. Chukwu is never a fighter. In the game, Chukwu is the silent origin of the Four Days and speaks only once, in the secret ending.
Elu Igwe (the Sky)	Realm of Amadioha, Anyanwụ and the sky powers. Thunder, sun and judgement live here.
Ala Igbo (the Living Earth)	The world of people, farms, markets and villages, watched over by Ala. Its heart is Ama-Ụwa, the Great Market at the Crossroads of Worlds, where the tournament is held.
Ala Mmụọ (the Spirit Land)	The home of ancestors (ndị ichie), masquerade spirits and the Chi of every living person. Ancestors judge the living here.
Ala Efu (the Hollow Land)	An original realm created by the villain: the Fifth Day, a day with no market, no oath and no consequence. Everything it touches becomes “efu”, empty.

3.2 The Four Market Days

The traditional Igbo week (izu) has four days: **Eke, Orie, Afọ and Nkwọ**. Markets, courts, festivals and journeys are organised around them. In Ọgụ Anọ, the Four Days are four ancient keeper-spirits who share power equally so that no one force can rule the world. Each day also shapes combat through the Market Clock (Section 6).

Day	Game aspect	Colour and symbol	Combat effect
Eke	Strength	Camwood red, the python coil	Heavy attacks gain armour and damage.
Orie	Speed	Indigo, flowing water	Faster movement, cancels and dashes.
Afọ	Trickery	Gold, the masquerade eye	Feints, teleports and command grabs are stronger.
Nkwọ	Counter	Forest green, the market drum	Blocks and counters recover meter and deal bonus damage.

> **Design note**
>
> The day-to-power mapping is an original gameplay design inspired by the cultural role of the market week. It is presented to players as the game’s own myth, not as traditional doctrine.

3.3 The Ọfọ

In Igbo tradition the Ọfọ is a staff or sacred symbol of truth, authority and justice, held by elders and priests, and invoked with Ogu (innocence and righteousness) when an oath is sworn. In the game it is the central relic: whoever holds the Ọfọ can bind spirits and humans to their word. The Ọfọ is shattered into five shards, which become the objectives of the story.

3.4 The Deities and Powers of the Game

Power	Domain (tradition)	Role in Ọgụ Anọ
Ala (Ana)	Earth, fertility, morality, custodian of the Ọfọ	Patron of Adaeze. Her law is the moral centre of the game.
Amadioha	Thunder, justice, oaths	Patron of Ikenna. Enforces oaths with lightning.
Anyanwụ	The Sun, light, truth	Patron of Nkiruka. The sun dims as the Fifth Day spreads.
Idemmili	Water spirit (honoured especially around Oguta), sacred python	Patron of Ezinne Idemmili. Guardian of Orie.
Ekwensu	War, fire, iron and the chaos of the market	An ambiguous power: antagonist, rival and uneasy ally. Depicted with respect for its original complexity.
Agwụ	Spirit of divination, medicine and creative frenzy	Source of Dibịa Okoro's powers, in both healing and risk.
Ogbunabali	"Killer by night", spirit of the dark hours	Mid-game boss, a test of courage in the Midnight Forest.
Ndị Ichie (ancestors)	Elders who guide the living from Ala Mmụọ	Judges of Adaeze's worthiness, source of Chi Awakening.

4. The Story

4.1 Themes

- **Accountability versus unchecked power.** The Fifth Day is a day with no consequences, and the story asks what a world without accountability becomes.
- **Destiny and agency.** The proverb “Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe” says that a person’s Chi agrees with their own determination: fate and effort work together.
- **Community over solitary rule.** Four days, four keepers and many voices keep the world safe; one ruler cannot.
- **Mercy and justice.** The Ọfọ Verdict system lets players feel the weight of choosing between them.

4.2 Prologue: Before the Fifth Day

The Elder Storyteller, Okenye Agụ, narrates over animated uli murals. Chukwu made the world and set the Four Days to give time a rhythm and to keep people honest at the market. Four spirits became the keepers of Eke, Orie, Afọ and Nkwọ. Ala, mother of the earth, holds the Ọfọ so that no one, human or spirit, can lie without consequence. Once each generation, the powers send their champions to the Great Market at Ama-Ụwa for **Ọgụ Anọ**, the Fight of Four, to renew the balance and name the new bearer of the Ọfọ.

But Eze Efu, once the wisest priest-king in the land, grew tired of obeying the Ọfọ. He wanted a day that belonged to him alone: **Ụbọchị Ise, the Fifth Day**, where no oath bound, no debt came due and no ancestor could judge. When the Ọgụ Anọ was called, he stole the Ọfọ, shattered it into five shards, and tore the Fifth Day into the week.

4.3 Chapter structure

Chapter 1: The Day the Market Fell Silent

Playable: Adaeze | Stage: Umuezeala Village Market

During an Eke market, Adaeze’s village of Umuezeala is hollowed. Villagers stand frozen, their Chi voices silenced. Her mother, a priestess of Ala, presses the first Ọfọ shard into her hands and dies protecting her. Tutorial fights against the Hollow Ones teach the controls; Adaeze learns that hollowed people can be freed, not destroyed.

Chapter 2: The Thunder That Does Not Lie

Playable: Adaeze, Ikenna | Stage: Oath Stone Grove

At the Oath Stone, Ikenna, champion of Amadioha, accuses Adaeze of stealing the Ọfọ. The first true story fight. Thunder reveals her innocence. Ikenna swears an oath to travel with her. First Ọfọ Verdict choice.

Chapter 3: The Lake of the Python

Playable: Ezinne Idemmili | Stage: Idemmili Lake Shrine

At the sacred lake, the water priestess tests Adaeze's honesty. The keeper of Orie is weakening; the flowing days are drying up. A battle in the shallows earns the second shard and the first alliance with a day-keeper.

Chapter 4: The Child Who Returns

Playable: Ngozi the Ogbanje | Stage: Rooftop Night Market

Ngozi, an ogbanje who has died and returned many times, stole a shard to protect it. She can see the edge of the Fifth Day because she has stood between worlds. A chase and duel across a rooftop market ends with Ngozi joining the party.

Chapter 5: Dawn Over the Ruins

Playable: Nkiruka | Stage: Ashen Savannah

The sun is dimming. Nkiruka, Daughter of the Sun, hunts hollowed warriors across a burnt savannah. She challenges the party, then recognises that the Fifth Day is eating Anyanwụ's light. Third shard.

Chapter 6: The Masks Remember

Playable: Ijele, Dibịa Okoro | Stage: Mmọnwụ Festival Ground

At a masquerade ground, the ancestors judge Adaeze through a ritual duel with Ijele. Dibịa Okoro reads Afa divination and reveals Eze Efu's secret: he was once the bearer of the Ọfọ and the teacher of Adaeze's mother. Fourth shard.

Chapter 7: The Bargain at the Crossroads

Playable: Ekwensu (unlocked) | Stage: Ama-Ụwa, the Great Market

At Ama-Ụwa, Ekwensu stands in the dust and offers a deal: he will fight the Hollow King if Adaeze grants him one favour. The player chooses to duel him, bargain or refuse. This choice influences the endings.

Chapter 8: Night Walks

Playable: Adaeze | Stage: Midnight Forest

Ogbunabali, the Killer by Night, tests the party's courage in a forest where Chi voices are silenced. A sub-boss fight with a lighting mechanic: Nkiruka's sun can be used to push the darkness back.

Chapter 9: The Fifth Day

Playable: Adaeze and chosen ally | Stage: Palace of the Hollow King

In the palace of the Hollow King, time runs backward and the Four Days are shut out. A three-phase final battle against Eze Efu. The ending is decided by the Ọfọ Verdict choices made throughout the game.

4.4 Endings

Ending	Condition	Outcome
The Four Days Return (True Ending)	Mostly Mercy verdicts, all five shards recovered	Eze Efu's hollow shell is cracked open, and he is returned to mortal form to answer before the ndị ichie. The market bells ring again.

Ending	Condition	Outcome
The Iron Order	Mostly Judgement verdicts	Adaeze defeats the king but rules through force with the whole Ọfọ. The final scene shows the first hollow shadow forming behind her: a warning about how power repeats itself.
The Hollow Dawn	Missing shards or failing the final fight	The Fifth Day persists. A bleak epilogue sets up a sequel.
Chi Speaks (Secret Ending)	All four day-keepers befriended, Ekwensu allied, all Mercy	Chukwu's voice speaks. The Four Days are renewed as five roles shared by all, and the final cutscene breaks the fourth wall: the player's own Chi "says yes".

4.5 The Villain: Eze Efu, the Hollow King

Eze Efu is not a monster who wants to destroy the world. He is a gifted leader who decided that rules were for other people. Having refused counsel from the ndị ichie, his own Chi stopped speaking to him, and the silence frightened him. He tried to fill it by silencing everyone else's Chi too. The tragedy is that he created exactly the emptiness he feared. This gives the finale emotional weight: Adaeze defeats him not by destroying him, but by choosing whether to restore him.

5. Character Roster

The launch roster has **8 playable fighters**, **2 bosses** and one narrator. Each fighter represents a different archetype so that every player finds a playstyle: grappler, rushdown, zoner, trickster, tank, flow fighter, setup specialist and wildcard.

Fighter	Archetype	Day affinity	Core idea
Adaeze	Grappler / all-rounder	Eke	Heavy hits, command grabs and the Ọfọ staff. The best entry point for new players.
Ikenna	Rushdown	Orie	Fast pressure with lightning dashes and the strength of the right hand (Ikenga).
Nkiruka	Zoner	Nkwọ	Controls space with discs of sunlight, and blinds with solar flare.
Ngozi	Trickster	Afọ	Teleports, traps and revives once per match through the Return.
Ijele	Tank	Eke	Huge health, armour, and ancestral dancers that shield him.
Ezinne Idemmili	Flow fighter	Orie	Stance-switching water style with python grabs.
Dibịa Okoro	Setup / support	Nkwọ	Reads Afa divination to predict attacks and plants spirit traps.
Ekwensu	Wildcard	Afọ	Steals Market Clock turns and trades health for raw power.
Ogbunabali (boss)	Sub-boss	None	Night spirit who fights with darkness and fear.
Eze Efu (boss)	Final boss	Fifth Day	Three-phase boss who breaks the Market Clock rules.

5.1 Rating overview (1 to 5)

Fighter	Power	Speed	Range	Defence	Technique
Adaeze	4	2	2	4	3
Ikenna	3	5	2	2	3
Nkiruka	2	3	5	2	4
Ngozi	2	4	3	2	5
Ijele	5	1	2	5	2
Ezinne Idemmili	3	3	3	3	4
Dibịa Okoro	2	2	4	3	5
Ekwensu	5	3	3	1	4

ADAEZE — Daughter of Ala, Bearer of the Broken Ọfọ

Origin	The fictional village of Umuezeala, Igbo heartland
Mythological source	Ala (Ana), the earth goddess and custodian of morality and the Ọfọ
Role / archetype	Protagonist; grappler and all-rounder
Fighting style	Wrestling-based power style: stomps, throws and staff strikes
Market Day affinity	Eke (Strength)
Strengths	High health, strong grabs, stable defence, forgiving for beginners
Weaknesses	Slow mobility, weak against zoning
Allies and rivals	Ally: Ikenna. Rival: Eze Efu (her mother's former student and teacher). Respected by Ala's earth.

Backstory. Adaeze grew up in a village of yam farmers, learning wrestling from her uncles and the law of Ala from her mother, a priestess. When Eze Efu's hollowing takes the village, she is left with a single shard of the Ọfọ and one instruction: bring the Four Days back. She does not want to be a hero. She wants her mother's voice back.

Visual design. Strong build, short natural hair wrapped in a head tie with camwood red dye. White nzu chalk markings on her arms and uli spirals painted on her shoulders. Wrapper skirt over wrestling trunks, bronze anklets, and the cracked Ọfọ staff on her back.

"Ala does not forget, and neither will I."

Move	Input	Effect
Ịkụ Ala (Earth Stomp)	↓ ↓ + HP	Slams the ground, sending a short tremor that launches grounded opponents.
Ọfọ Sweep	↓ → + LK	Low staff sweep that knocks down; safe on block during Eke.
Nkume Ala (Rising Stone)	→ ↓ → + P	Anti-air uppercut with a rock shard erupting from the floor.
Ala Grip	LP + LK	Command grab. During Eke, deals extra damage and slams the opponent into the stage.

Signature finisher: Ikpe Ala (Judgement of Earth)

On Judgement the ground opens beneath the defeated fighter, and Ala's hand closes over them; on Mercy, Adaeze plants the Ọfọ and the earth gently lifts them to their feet.

IKENNA — The Hand of Thunder

Origin	Oath Stone Grove, a border region between villages
Mythological source	Amadioha (thunder and justice) and the Ikenga, the Igbo symbol of the right hand and personal achievement
Role / archetype	Rushdown fighter and Adaeze's first ally

Fighting style	Aggressive boxing with lightning-fast dashes
Market Day affinity	Orie (Speed)
Strengths	Fast pressure, strong combos, excellent mobility
Weaknesses	Low health, vulnerable when his rush is blocked
Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze. Rival: Ekwensu. Sworn to Amadioha's law.

Backstory. Ikenna is the champion of Amadioha, trained since childhood to enforce oaths. He believes in justice with absolute certainty, which makes him dangerous when he is wrong. Learning that Adaeze is innocent teaches him that justice without listening is just noise.

Visual design. Lean fighter in a red cap with eagle feather, a carved Ikenga ram-horned figure at his belt, and a right hand wrapped in lightning-scarred bandages. White chalk across the brow.

"My right hand does not strike without cause."

Move	Input	Effect
Ikenga Strike	→ → + HP	A dash punch that carries momentum; cancels into specials.
Ọkụ Eluigwe (Thunderbolt)	↓ ← + P	Fires a short lightning bolt; stronger when charged during Orie.
Amadioha's Verdict	→ ↓ → + K	Anti-air lightning kick, invincible on startup.
Oath Break	HP + HK	Armour-breaking overhead that shatters defences.

Signature finisher: Egbe Eluigwe (Sky Judgement)

Judgement calls a column of lightning; Mercy sees Ikenna lower his fist and offer his hand.

NKIRUKA — Daughter of the Sun

Origin	The Ashen Savannah, a land the sun is abandoning
Mythological source	Anyanwụ, the Sun, and the concept of light as truth
Role / archetype	Zoner, ranged fighter
Fighting style	Throws discs of solar light and controls space
Market Day affinity	Nkwọ (Counter)
Strengths	Superb range control, flexible projectiles, strong anti-rushdown tools
Weaknesses	Fragile up close, limited health
Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze after Chapter 5. Rival: Ogbunabali (night versus sun).

Backstory. Her name means "what is yet to come is greater". Nkiruka was raised by sun-priests who believed the world would end if the sun ever grew cold. As the Fifth Day blocks the dawn, she is forced to ask whether her hope is faith or denial.

Visual design. Golden skin tones, braided crown with copper discs, light armour of woven raffia and gold. Eyes glow like early morning.

"The dawn does not ask permission."

Move	Input	Effect
Anyanwụ Disc	↓ → + P	Throws a spinning disc of light; can be thrown high or low.
Solar Flare	↓ ← + K	Blinds the opponent for a short time, reducing their input range.
Dawn Step	→ ↓ + K	Short teleport to the other side, enabling mix-ups.
Light Lance	HP + HK	A long-range spear of light that pierces projectiles.

Signature finisher: Ụzọ Ìhè (Path of Light)

Judgement burns a beam across the screen; Mercy releases a warm light that heals the loser's hollowing.

NGOZI — The Ogbanje Who Returns

Origin	The streets of a rooftop night market
Mythological source	The ogbanje tradition: a spirit child who repeatedly dies and returns to the same family, bound by an iyi-uwa object
Role / archetype	Trickster, teleporter
Fighting style	Evasive, trap-based, unpredictable
Market Day affinity	Afọ (Trickery)
Strengths	Teleports, traps, once-per-match revival
Weaknesses	Low damage per hit, demanding to play
Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze. Rival: Ogbunabali, from whom she has barely escaped many times.

Backstory. Ngozi has died and come back so many times that she no longer fears either side. She can see the edge of the Fifth Day because she has already stood between worlds. She guards her buried iyi-uwa fiercely, since breaking it would end her returning forever.

Visual design. Slim, with a silver anklet and faint spirals along her arms. Bright eyes that shift between children's curiosity and ancient weariness.

"I have been dead before. You are not scary."

Move	Input	Effect
Return (passive)	Automatic	Once per match, revives at 20% health after a short spirit animation.
Iyi-Uwa Trap	↓ ↓ + P	Places a buried charm that explodes when the opponent steps on it.

Move	Input	Effect
Ogbanje Step	← ← + K	Short teleport behind the opponent.
Cry of the Returning	HP + LK	A shriek that stuns the opponent briefly.

Signature finisher: Ọgbanje Ọdachi (Spirit Fall)

Judgement sends the loser tumbling through the spirit world; Mercy sees Ngozi bury a charm to protect them.

IJELE — The Towering Mask

Origin	A masquerade festival ground, Ala Mmụọ border
Mythological source	Mmọnwụ (masquerade) tradition, including Ijele, the grandest Igbo masquerade
Role / archetype	Tank and ancestral guardian
Fighting style	Slow, powerful strikes and dance-based defence
Market Day affinity	Eke (Strength)
Strengths	Highest health, armour on heavy attacks, ancestral chorus shields
Weaknesses	Very slow, easy to out-zone
Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze after judging her. Rival: Ekwensu.

Backstory. Ijele is not one person but a collective of ancestors wearing the masquerade's form. Masquerades embody the spirit world meeting the living, and Ijele's role is to test whether the living deserve their inheritance.

Visual design. A huge, layered, colourful tower of cloth, mirrors, feathers and carved figures. Underneath, only a pair of shining eyes.

"We were here before your grandfathers' grandfathers."

Move	Input	Effect
Ijele Spin	↓ ← + P	Large spinning attack that hits both sides.
Mask Charge	← → + K	Armoured charge that breaks through light attacks.
Ancestral Chorus	↓ ↓ + K	Summons dancers that block one hit and heal slightly.
Egwu Stomp	HP + HK	Heavy stomp that creates a rhythm shockwave.

Signature finisher: Egwu Ndị Ichie (Dance of the Ancestors)

Judgement has ancestral dancers surround and carry the defeated into the dark; Mercy has them circle and bless the loser.

EZINNE IDEMMILI — Priestess of the Lake

Origin	The shrine at the lake of the python
Mythological source	Idemmili, a water spirit honoured in Igbo tradition, with the python as a sacred animal
Role / archetype	Flow fighter, stance changer
Fighting style	Switches between “Flow” and “Coil” stances
Market Day affinity	Orie (Speed)
Strengths	Fluid combos, safe movement, grabs
Weaknesses	Needs stance management; low damage when stunned
Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze. Rival: Ekwensu, whose fire dries her lake.

Backstory. Ezinne has served at the shrine since childhood, keeping the python and the water pure. She tests every pilgrim’s honesty. When the lake starts to dry, she realises the Fifth Day is eating Orie.

Visual design. Indigo wrappers that flow like water, beads at the wrists, and a living python that wraps her shoulders like a scarf.

“Water remembers every promise.”

Move	Input	Effect
Flow Stance	↓ ← + P	Faster movement, safe cancels.
Python Coil	→ ↓ + LP	Command grab that binds and pulls the opponent.
Tide Slide	↓ → + K	Low slide that crosses half the screen.
Oguta Surge	HP + LK	A wave attack that pushes back projectiles.

Signature finisher: Ọkụ Mmiri (Drowning of Truth)

Judgement drowns the loser in rising water; Mercy has the python gently deliver them to the shore.

DIBỊA OKORO — Reader of Afa

Origin	A hut at the edge of the Mmọnwụ ground
Mythological source	The dibịa (healer-diviner) tradition, Afa divination, and the spirit Agwụ
Role / archetype	Setup, support and prediction
Fighting style	Reads the opponent’s next move and punishes it
Market Day affinity	Nkwọ (Counter)
Strengths	Counters, traps, buffs and healing
Weaknesses	Low raw damage, needs time to set up

Allies and rivals	Ally: Adaeze, whom he trusts after reading her Afa. Rival: Eze Efu, who once broke his oath.

Backstory. Okoro is a diviner who sees the connections between everyone's Chi. Agwụ gave him gifts, but also moments of madness. He does not fear the Fifth Day; he fears being unable to read it.

Visual design. Layered white garments, a red cap with feather, a cowrie-shell belt, and a divination chain at his waist.

"Afa has already told me what you will do."

Move	Input	Effect
Afa Reading	↓ ↓ + HP	Briefly reveals the opponent's next attack, enabling a perfect counter.
Ogwu Cloud	↓ ← + P	Releases herbal smoke that slows the opponent.
Aja Throw	→ → + LP	Throws sacrificial sand that blinds briefly.
Healing Chant	↓ ↓ ↓ + K	Recovers a small amount of health while standing still.

Signature finisher: Ikpe Afa (The Divination's Verdict)

The Afa chain falls, and the result is Judgement or Mercy exactly as the divination reads.

EKWENSU — Lord of the Rising Dust

Origin	Ama-Ụwa, the Great Market
Mythological source	Ekwensu, a power associated with war, fire, iron and the bargaining energy of markets in Igbo tradition
Role / archetype	Wildcard, unlocked in Chapter 7
Fighting style	Reckless offence, high risk and high reward
Market Day affinity	Afọ (Trickery)
Strengths	Highest damage, steals Market Clock turns
Weaknesses	Lowest defence, loses health when using powerful moves
Allies and rivals	Ambiguous; may fight or ally with Adaeze depending on choices.

Backstory. Ekwensu is not purely villain or hero. He is the energy of ambition, trade, war and risk that every market needs, but cannot control. He hates the Fifth Day because a day with no consequences is a market with no deals.

Visual design. Dark skin, iron plates across the shoulders, a fiery cloak of red dust, and a face half-hidden behind a masked blade.

"Every bargain has a price. Even this one."

Move	Input	Effect
Iron Rain	↓ → + P	Throws a cascade of iron shards that hit three times.
Market Mayhem	↓ ↓ + K	Steals one Market Clock turn, forcing the next day to his advantage.
Ekwensu's Bargain	HP + HK	Trade 10% health for a 30% damage boost for 8 seconds.
Dust Charge	← → + P	A dash that creates a trail of burning dust.

> **Signature finisher: Ọgụ Ekwensu (The Last Bargain)**
>
> Judgement forces the loser to sign away something; Mercy leaves Ekwensu laughing, and a smaller bargain is struck.

5.2 Boss fights

Ogbunabali, Killer by Night

A sub-boss in the Midnight Forest whose attacks come from the dark. The stage grows darker over time, hiding his silhouette; Nkiruka's Solar Flare and Chi Awakening can briefly light the arena. His signature is the **Night Hand**, a long-reaching grab from the shadows that players must read from sound cues. Defeating him with Mercy leaves him as a neutral spirit; with Judgement, he fades into the dark.

Eze Efu, the Hollow King

Phase	Description
Phase 1: The King's Court	A traditional fight: strong, regal strikes with the shards of the Ọfọ orbiting him. The Market Clock works normally.
Phase 2: The Fifth Day	The clock stops cycling and starts running backward. The active day changes unpredictably, forcing players to adapt. Hollow Ones join the arena.
Phase 3: The Empty Crown	The arena turns into a vast white void. Eze Efu's Chi appears, silent and chained. Players must break the chains using the Chi Awakening mechanic, and then choose the Ọfọ Verdict.

6. Gameplay Design

6.1 Core loop

Choose a fighter, enter a stage, win two of three rounds, then make the Ọfọ Verdict choice. Story mode adds cutscenes between fights. The core fighting flow is quick to learn and deep to master: light attacks, heavy attacks, blocking, specials, combos, throws and the Market Clock.

6.2 The Market Clock (signature mechanic)

Each fight has a **Market Clock** shown as a circular dial. The clock moves through Eke, Orie, Afọ and Nkwọ, advancing every 10 seconds. The active day gives all fighters a small bonus to a particular style. Fighters who match the active day (their affinity) receive a larger bonus. Players can spend a Day Shift (using one bar of Ọfọ meter) to force the clock forward one day early, creating tactical choices.

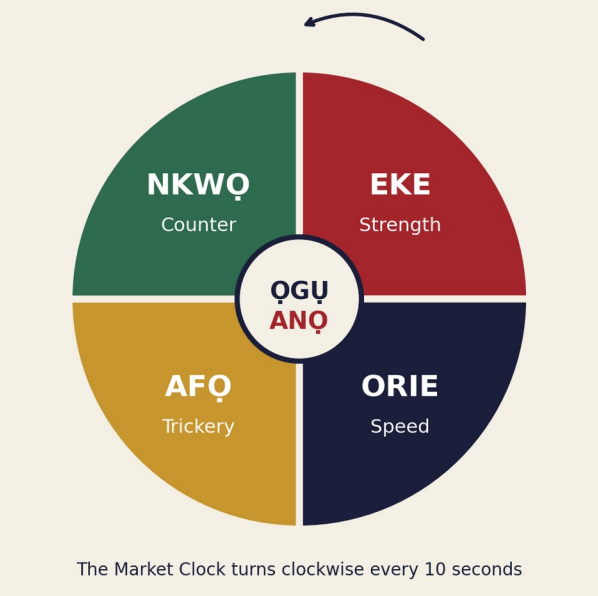


Figure 1. The Market Clock turns clockwise every 10 seconds.

Day	Global effect (all fighters)	Affinity bonus (matching fighters)
Eke	Heavy attacks +10% damage and light armour	+10% more damage, +1 armour hit on heavies
Orie	+10% movement and dash speed	One free cancel per combo
Afọ	Throws and feints hit 15% faster	Teleports and command grabs gain extra range
Nkwọ	Successful blocks recover meter	Counters deal +20% damage

6.3 Other core systems

System	How it works
Health	1000 points per fighter; best of three rounds; 60-second round timer.

System	How it works
Ọfọ Meter	Three bars. Fills by attacking and blocking. Spent on enhanced specials (1 bar), Day Shift (1 bar) and Super moves (3 bars).
Chi Awakening	Once per match, when health falls below 20%, the fighter's Chi appears behind them for 10 seconds: +25% damage, slow health recovery and a unique visual effect.
Ọfọ Verdict	After the final round, the winner chooses Ebere (Mercy) or Ikpe (Judgement). In story mode this affects the ending; in versus mode it triggers different finishing animations and awards different cosmetic rewards.
Hollow status	Some enemies and the final boss can apply "Hollow", which temporarily reduces meter gain; cured by Chi Awakening or Mercy verdicts.

6.4 Game modes

- **Story Mode:** 9 chapters with cutscenes, branching choices and four endings.
- **Versus:** local two-player and online play with rollback netcode.
- **Ọgụ Anọ Tournament:** an arcade-style ladder of eight opponents with character-specific endings.
- **Survival:** fight endless Hollow Ones and earn Heritage Codex entries.
- **Training:** frame data, hitboxes, input display, dummy recording.
- **Heritage Codex:** reading mode with myths, history, language lessons and artwork.

6.5 Controls

Action	Keyboard	Gamepad	Touch
Move	A / D, W jump, S crouch	Left stick / D-pad	Virtual joystick
Light / Heavy Punch	J / K	X / Y	Two right-side buttons
Light / Heavy Kick	U / I	A / B	Two right-side buttons
Block	L	RB	Hold block button
Day Shift	O	LB	Dial icon
Special shortcut	Hold Shift + direction	RT + direction	Swipe gestures (assist mode)

Touch controls include an **Assist Mode** where specials can be triggered by simple swipes, so newcomers can enjoy the game before learning motion inputs.

6.6 Baseline combat numbers

Attack type	Startup (frames)	Damage	Notes
Light attack	5	30	Fast, safe, chains into other lights.
Heavy attack	12	80	Slower, can armour-break during Eke.

Attack type	Startup (frames)	Damage	Notes
Special move	10 to 18	90 to 140	Depends on character; most are cancelable.
Throw	7	110	Cannot be blocked; can be teched.
Super move	8 + flash	250	Costs 3 bars of Ọfọ meter.

6.7 Difficulty, balance and progression

- **Difficulty:** Story (relaxed), Normal, Hard and Master AI, plus accessibility options for reduced timing windows.
- **Balance:** each character is tested against all others with a target of 45% to 55% win rate in simulated matches; no fighter exceeds 8 of 10 in any single matchup.
- **Progression:** earn “Chi Marks” by completing story chapters and challenges, unlocking colour palettes, character titles, stage variants and Codex entries.
- **Unlockables:** Ekwensu (Chapter 7), Ogbunabali (complete Tournament on Hard), Eze Efu (true ending), plus a “Masquerade Mode” of alternate costumes.

7. Stages and Environments

Stage	Setting	Gameplay and mood
Umuezeala Village Market	Rural market square	Starting stage. Mud-brick stalls, yam heaps, and the smell of smoke. Background crowds react to the fight.
Oath Stone Grove	Forest clearing with a sacred stone	Thunderclouds gather; lightning strikes in the background during Orie.
Idemmili Lake Shrine	Lakeside shrine with stepping stones	Water ripples with each heavy hit; the python sculpture glows.
Rooftop Night Market	Crowded urban rooftops	Neon lights mixed with traditional lanterns; background characters sell and cheer.
Ashen Savannah	Burnt grassland at dawn	The sun rises and sets according to the Market Clock.
Mmọnwụ Festival Ground	Masquerade arena	Dancers, drummers and spirits form the audience; the crowd's energy fills the Ọfọ meter faster.
Ama-Ụwa, the Great Market	Crossroads of Worlds	Tournament stage with a central drum and banners for each day.
Midnight Forest	Dark forest	Visibility reduced; sound cues matter.
Palace of the Hollow King	White void palace	Final stage; the Market Clock appears as a vast stone wheel in the sky.

8. Art Direction

8.1 Visual identity

The art style is **stylised 2D with hand-painted textures**, combining the dramatic silhouettes of classic fighting games with Igbo visual language. The core principle is “Uli in motion”: the flowing, curved line patterns of uli body and wall art form the basis for effects, UI ornaments and character markings.

Element	Direction
Palette	Deep indigo (night, water), camwood red (earth, life), gold (sun, authority), chalk white (nzu, purity) and forest green (growth, counter).
Patterns	Uli spirals, geometric Nsibidi-inspired symbols, mudcloth-inspired textures, carved wood grain.
Characters	Strong silhouettes, clear costume colours, traditional clothing reimagined for combat; no gore, cuts show as light flashes.
Effects	Hits spark in uli-shaped bursts; specials trigger painted symbols across the screen; Chi Awakening shows a translucent ancestral figure.
Cinematics	Animated uli murals for the prologue and epilogue; in-engine cutscenes for chapters.
References	Igbo wall paintings, Igbo Ukwu bronzes, masquerade costumes, Nri-inspired shrines, and contemporary African illustration.

8.2 Asset list for the vertical slice

- 2 fighters (Adaeze, Ikenna) with idle, walk, jump, 12 attacks, hit reactions and win/lose poses.
- 1 stage (Umuezeala Village Market) with parallax layers and animated background crowd.
- UI kit: health bars, Ọfọ meter, Market Clock, round indicators, menus.
- 15 sound effects and 1 music loop.

9. Audio Direction

Sound is how the game announces itself as Igbo from the first second. The score blends traditional instruments with modern production and Igbo highlife rhythms.

Layer	Direction
Instruments	Ogene (metal gong), ekwe (slit drum), igba (drum), udu (clay pot drum), ọja (flute), ichaka (shakers), and mbira-like plucked tones, mixed with bass, synth pads and modern percussion.
Stage music	Each stage has a signature rhythm: slow and heavy for Eke, flowing for Orie, syncopated and playful for Afọ, steady and martial for Nkwọ. Music shifts subtly when the Market Clock changes day.
Voice	Igbo dialogue with English subtitles. Native Igbo voice actors, with proverbs spoken at round start and win quotes.
SFX	Hits layered with natural sounds: wood, water, thunder, bells. Announcer calls: “Ọgụ ahụ bidoro!” (The fight has begun!).
Adaptive audio	At Chi Awakening, a chorus of voices (the ancestors) joins the music.

10. User Interface and Experience

- **Main menu:** a market-stall layout where each stall is a mode: Story, Versus, Tournament, Survival, Training, Codex.
- **HUD:** health bars carved like wooden beams, an Ọfọ meter as three beads, and a Market Clock dial centred above the round timer.
- **Character select:** a circle of masks; selecting a fighter shows their Codex card with the myth behind them.
- **Loading screens:** rotating Igbo proverbs with translations and explanations.
- **Accessibility:** colour-blind palettes, adjustable text size, high-contrast outlines, optional subtitles with speaker names, control remapping, one-handed layouts and screen-reader support for menus.
- **Onboarding:** a 5-minute interactive tutorial in the voice of Okenye Agụ, introducing movement, attacks, blocking, the Market Clock and verdicts.

11. Language and Cultural Integration

11.1 Igbo phrases used in the game

Igbo	Meaning	Use in game
Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe	When a person says yes, their Chi says yes	Game motto, title screen, secret ending
Igwe bụ ike	Unity is strength	Loading screen and co-op messaging
Egbe bere, ugo bere	Let the kite perch and let the eagle perch (live and let live)	Mercy verdict quote
Ọgụ ahụ bidoro	The fight has begun	Announcer line at round start
Ndewo	Hello / greetings	Narrator and menu greeting
Ndị ichie	The ancestors / elders	Chi Awakening and ancestor scenes
Ebere	Mercy	Verdict choice
Ikpe	Judgement	Verdict choice

Language quality plan

All Igbo text, including diacritics and tone marks, will be reviewed by at least two native speakers or Igbo-language lecturers before release, and voice lines will be recorded with native speakers. Where dialects differ (Owerri, Onitsha, Nsukka), the game will use Standard Igbo and credit the dialect advisors.

11.2 Authenticity map: tradition versus adaptation

A strong cultural submission shows exactly where it follows tradition and where it invents. This table will also appear in the in-game Heritage Codex.

Element	Traditional basis	Adaptation in the game
Four market days	The Igbo week (izu) has four days: Eke, Orie, Afọ, Nkwọ.	Day-spirits as keepers and combat modifiers are original design.
Ọfọ	A symbol of truth, authority and justice held by elders and priests.	Becomes a shattered relic and plot device.
Chi	A personal spiritual guide and part of a person's destiny.	Visualised as an ancestral figure behind each fighter.
Ala	Earth goddess, guardian of morality.	Patron of the protagonist.
Amadioha	Deity of thunder and justice.	Patron of Ikenna; thunder enforces oaths.
Anyanwụ	The Sun, associated with light and truth.	Patron of Nkiruka.
Idemmili	Water spirit with the python as sacred.	Patron of Ezinne Idemmili.

Element	Traditional basis	Adaptation in the game
Ekwensu	A power linked to war and the unsettled energy of the market; later misinterpreted as the “devil” by outsiders.	Shown as an ambiguous, respectable figure, neither pure villain nor hero.
Ogbanje	A spirit child who repeatedly dies and returns; a deeply felt idea in many families.	Ngozi is treated with dignity as a heroine, not a horror figure.
Masquerades	Mmọnwụ embody ancestors; Ijele is among the grandest masquerades.	Ijele as a collective of ancestors; shown with reverence.
Eze Efu and the Fifth Day	Not part of tradition.	Original villain and concept built to dramatise accountability.

11.3 Cultural respect principles

- Present the myths as heritage storytelling and cultural education, not as instructions for worship.
- Treat sacred symbols and masquerades with reverence; never mock them or use them as cheap jokes.
- Consult elders, cultural historians and Igbo studies scholars for review before release.
- Credit sources and cultural advisors in the game and the Codex.
- Make clear in the Codex what is traditional and what is invented.

12. Technical Design

Area	Plan
Engine	Godot 4 (GDScript, with C# optional). Chosen for being free and open source, small export size, strong 2D tools, and efficient Android builds.
Platforms	Android 8.0+ (primary), Windows 10+, optional Linux. A web demo build for judges.
Target performance	60 FPS on mid-range Android phones, build size under 500 MB, load times under 5 seconds.
Architecture	State-machine-based character controller; data-driven move lists in JSON/resources; separate hitbox, hurtbox and pushbox layers; deterministic fixed timestep for fair fights and rollback.
Online play	Peer-to-peer rollback netcode, with a lightweight lobby and matchmaking service.
AI	Behaviour-tree opponents with Story, Normal, Hard and Master tiers; boss scripts for Ogbunabali and Eze Efu.
Tools	Godot, Krita (art), Aseprite or Spine (animation), Blender (optional), LMMS or Reaper (music), Audacity (SFX), Git and GitHub (version control).
Localisation	English and Igbo at launch, with a structure ready for Yoruba, Hausa, French and Portuguese.
Quality assurance	Automated input tests, balance simulations, device testing on 5 Android models, community beta tests.

12.1 Scope: what exists at each stage

Milestone	Contents
Contest prototype	2 fighters, 1 stage, Market Clock, basic UI, one story cutscene, gameplay trailer.
Alpha	5 fighters, 5 stages, story chapters 1 to 5, online prototype.
Beta	8 fighters, 9 stages, full story, Codex, localisation, balance pass.
Launch	Full game with 4 endings, bosses, achievements and storefront materials.

13. Production Plan

13.1 Team roles

Role	Responsibility
Game director / designer	Vision, GDD, combat design, balance, contest submission.
Programmer(s)	Core engine work, character systems, UI, networking, tools.
2D artist / animator	Character art, animation, stage backgrounds, UI.
Narrative designer / writer	Story, dialogue, Codex, proverbs and lore.
Composer / sound designer	Music, SFX, voice direction.
Cultural and language advisors	Review of myths, language and visual details.
QA and community	Testing, feedback, social media and Discord.

A solo developer or small team can start with one person covering multiple roles. The first priority is to recruit an artist and a cultural advisor.

13.2 Risk register

Risk	Level	Mitigation
Scope too large for the team	High	Lock a vertical slice first; add characters one by one; cut the online mode if needed.
Cultural misrepresentation	Medium	Advisors, review checkpoints, an authenticity map and open credits.
Animation workload	High	Reuse base rigs, limit frames per move, use effects to sell impact.
Balance problems	Medium	Early playtests, automated simulations, community beta.
Mobile performance	Medium	Test on low-end phones early; optimise atlases and particles.
Budget and funding	Medium	Free tools, grants, crowdfunding, contest prizes and publisher pitches.
Power and internet instability	Medium	Offline-first design, small downloads, local multiplayer.

Appendix A: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Ọgụ	Fight, war, contest.
Anọ	Four.
Izu	The Igbo four-day week.
Eke, Orie, Afọ, Nkwọ	The four market days.
Chukwu / Chineke	The supreme creator.
Chi	A personal spirit and part of one's destiny.
Ala (Ana)	The earth goddess, guardian of morality.
Ọfọ	Staff or symbol of truth and authority.
Ndị ichie	Ancestors and elders.
Mmọnwụ	Masquerade, the embodiment of spirits.
Dibịa	Traditional healer and diviner.
Afa	The Igbo divination system.
Ogbanje	A spirit child who dies and returns.
Uli	Traditional Igbo body and wall design.
Nzu	White chalk used in rituals and blessing.
Ebere / Ikpe	Mercy / Judgement (the game's verdict choices).

Appendix B: Sources and Further Reading

The following are published works on Igbo history, religion and art that inform this design. The final production will verify all details with cultural advisors.

- Chinua Achebe, **Things Fall Apart**, **Arrow of God**, and the essays collected in **Morning Yet on Creation Day**.
- Elizabeth Isichei, **A History of the Igbo People**.
- Victor C. Uchendu, **The Igbo of Southeast Nigeria**.
- E. Ikenga Metuh, **God and Man in African Religion: A Case Study of the Igbo of Nigeria**.
- M. A. Onwuejeogwu, **An Igbo Civilization: Nri Kingdom and Hegemony**.
- Herbert M. Cole and Chike C. Aniakor, **Igbo Arts: Community and Cosmos**.
- Ogonna Chibuzo Agu, a doctoral thesis on the Nri-Igbo concept of Chi (SOAS, University of London, 1990).
- Interviews and review sessions with elders, language lecturers and cultural scholars in Imo State and beyond (planned).

Credits and acknowledgements

Design and concept by Ike Christopher Ugochukwu. This document is a pre-production design proposal. All characters, systems and story elements marked as original are creative adaptations inspired by Igbo tradition.